

Adaptive Thresholding Improves Recall in Low-Signal Retrieval

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Abstract

We report that adaptive per-query thresholding raises recall@20 from 0.61 to 0.74 on a low-signal retrieval benchmark, at a precision cost of 0.03.

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1. Method

Thresholds are set per query using the score gap between the top result and the median of the top fifty. Evaluation uses a single held-out split.

2. Limitations

One benchmark, one split, no ablation over the gap statistic. The precision cost may be underestimated because the annotation pool was shallow.